Clearline

Executive summary of the working paper

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The problem. Real-economy stablecoin payments reached an estimated US$350–550 billion in 2025 (BCG; about US$390 billion per McKinsey/Artemis), roughly 1% of gross stablecoin transfers (Reap, August 2026). But a blockchain transfer is not a completed business payment. Payments arrive short, on the wrong network, in counterfeit tokens, without a reference, twice, or to a look-alike address. Finance teams sort them out by hand, after the money has moved.

The product. Clearline is a read-only layer for businesses paid straight into their own wallets: (1) a payment page per invoice with the exact amount, the issuer's token contract, the network, and an address checker that warns the payer about look-alike addresses; (2) deterministic checks with evidence; (3) conservative matching, never decided by amount alone; (4) plain-English explanations and replies; (5) accounting entries that post only after a person approves (Xero connection in testing). Counterfeit, failed and wrong-network payments are never posted. Clearline never holds funds or wallet keys.

What works, and what doesn't yet. All seven payment situations play through to the books in the demo with a fictional company. Live mode is thinner: someone pastes the transaction ID; nothing watches addresses or polls confirmations; correct payments are marked paid by a person; with one shared treasury address most payments need a person to assign them; payment pages are Ethereum only. Xero has not run on a live organisation, and its permissions need updating to Xero's 2026 granular scopes. There is no sign-in, and Xero tokens are stored unencrypted.

Evidence. 46 tests cover Clearline's own request and accounting code. The checking engine it reuses, from an earlier product, was correct on 59/59 and 52/52 real public transactions with sample company data. **No customers or customer calls yet**; outreach began 29 October 2026.

Competition. HitPay already gives Singapore merchants stablecoin acceptance through a licensed partner; Stripe supports USDC but not USDT and caps transactions at US$10,000; Request Finance offers crypto invoicing, and its protocol logs payment references on-chain. Our untested hypothesis: the gap is businesses whose payers send plain transfers to the business's own wallet.

Business (hypotheses). First buyers in Singapore and Hong Kong; Tron payment pages come first. Pilot US$300 for 30 days, then US$200/month. A bottom-up guess (500–2,000 businesses) gives US$1.2–4.8M a year: a small business unless it grows into partners, more regions or a shared standard.

Biggest risks. Unproven demand; processors or Request Finance solving it first; licensing if anything ever touches funds; unsettled accounting treatment of stablecoins; one founder.

Next 90 days. Tron pages; address watching and confirmation polling; sign-in, encrypted tokens and granular Xero scopes; the Xero Demo Company test; 20 customer calls; 3 paid pilots measured on real exceptions.